

Simplified Travel

Mid-term presentation in User-Centered Design

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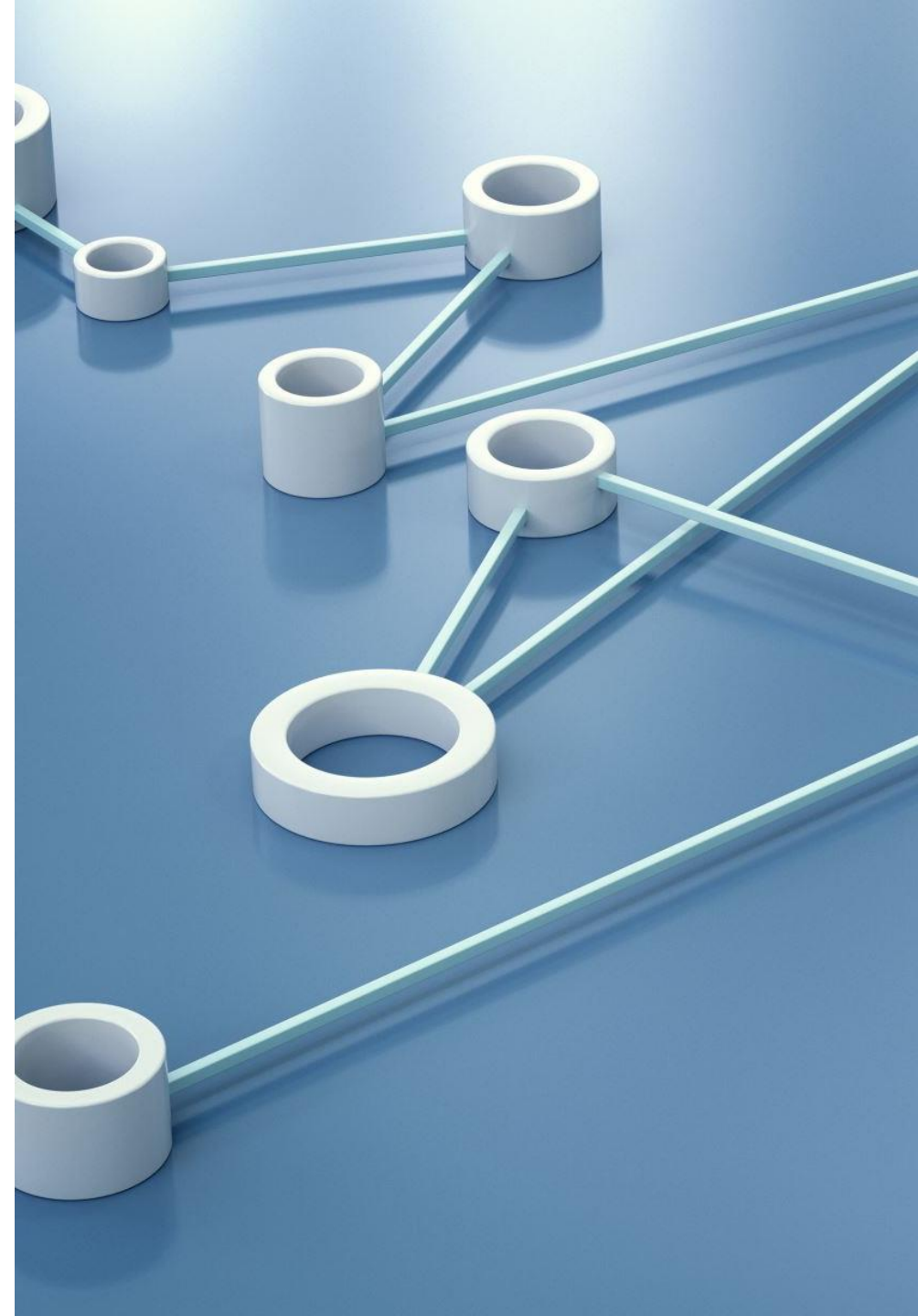
Understanding the Design Challenge

Objective:

Addressing the needs of both internal stakeholders and external market demands to create a user-centered travel app that meets business goals, customer needs, and aligns with current market trends.

Challenges:

- Balancing comfort, simplicity, and flexibility in the app design.
- Catering to diverse user preferences, from budget-conscious travelers to comfort-seekers.
- Differentiating from competitors by offering a unique, user-friendly experience.



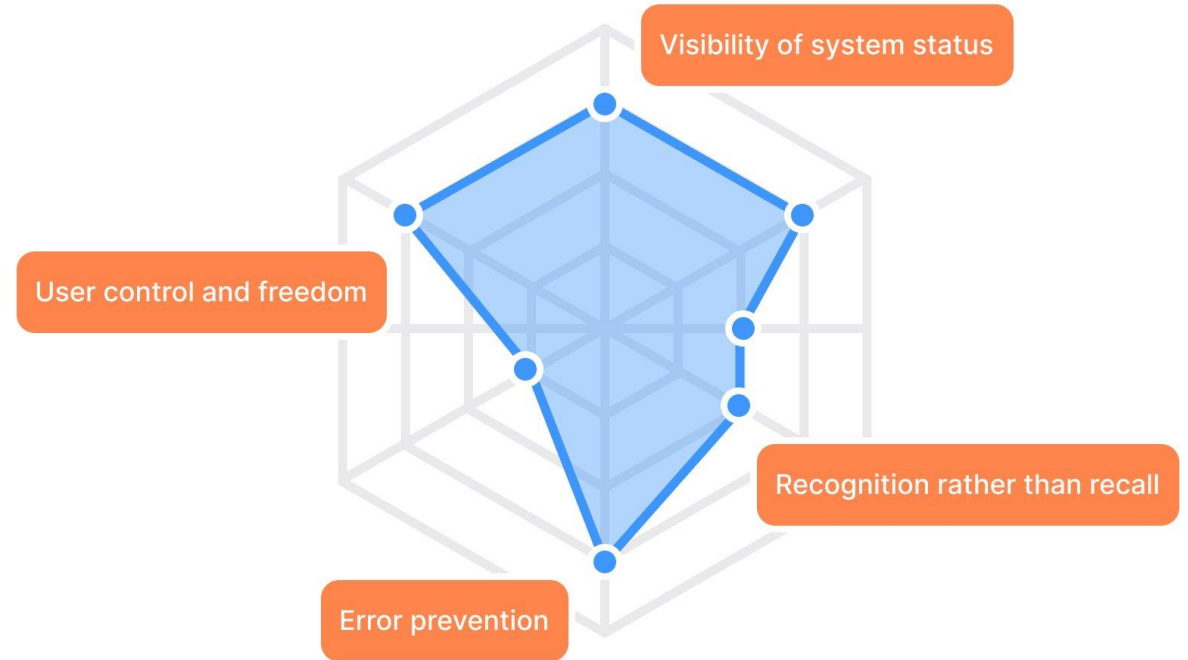
Best practices and Inspiration

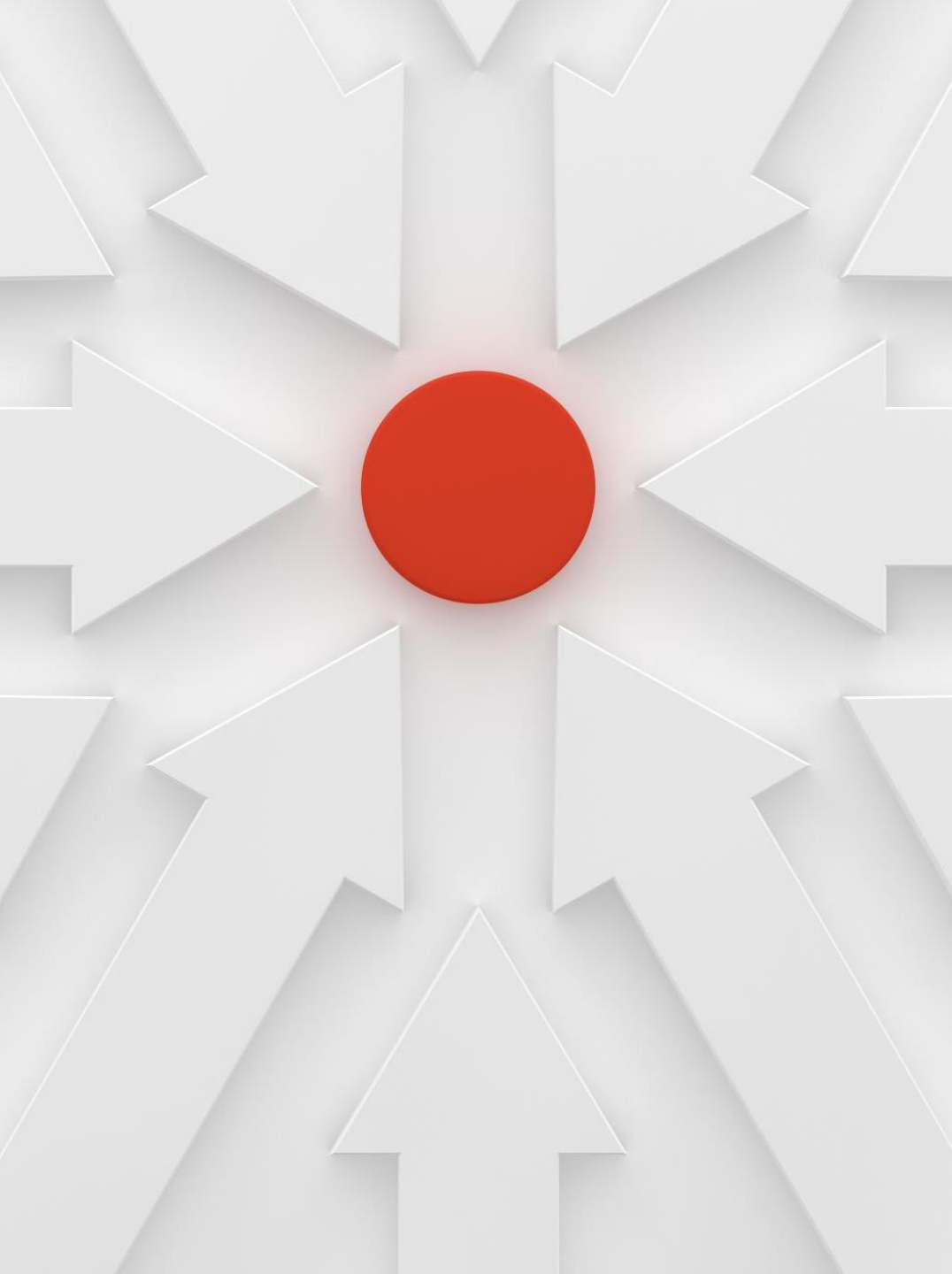
Nielsen heuristics (1993)

- User control and freedom
- Recognition rather than recall
- Aesthetic and Minimalist Design (Simplicity in UX)

Ergonomic criteria of Bastien and Scapin (1993)

- Guidance
- Homogeneity and consistency





Why did we choose them?

User control and freedom

- **Description:** Allows users to navigate freely, for example having the option to undo or redo actions.
- **Argument:** We chose this practice because it empowers users, making the interface more forgiving and less stressful. The benefit of it is that it reduces user anxiety by offering control over actions, improving satisfaction and confidence. The limitation might be too much complexity if too many controls are provided, potentially overwhelming less experienced users.

Recognition rather than recall

- **Description:** Ensures that the system is self-explanatory, with intuitive navigation so users don't have to remember previous actions to reach their destination.
- **Argument:** This makes the interface accessible to both new and returning users, minimizing cognitive load. Also, it enhances the ease of use by allowing users to focus on the current task without retracing steps, which is particularly helpful in applications like travel planning.

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design (Simplicity in UX)

- **Description:** Focuses on keeping the interface clean and uncluttered, showing only relevant information.
- **Argument:** We think that a minimalist design enhances readability and reduces distraction, making the app accessible and appealing, catering to our both Personas introduced later in this presentation. The consequence of this can be that sometimes oversimplifying can potentially lead to lack of necessary details for the user.

Guidance

- **Description:** Provides clear directions, prompts, and feedback to assist new users throughout their journey.
- **Argument:** Our opinion is that guidance helps users navigate smoothly, especially first-time users who need clear instructions. Benefit could be that it reduces error rates and boosts confidence by ensuring users know what to do at each step. Potential limitation might be over-guidance, which sometimes can be intrusive for experienced users, who may find prompts unnecessary and get lost in the application.

Homogeneity and consistency

- **Description:** Ensures that similar functions and visuals are consistent throughout the interface.
- **Argument:** Consistency builds familiarity, enabling users to predict actions and reducing learning time. Pros could be user comfort enhancement by creating corresponding patterns, improving overall user experience. Consequence could be that too much focus on consistency can limit flexibility, reducing the adaptability of the interface for varied tasks.



Interviewees Characteristics											
	Gender	Age	Comfort	Type of Traveler	Revisitin Traveler	Luggage	Prepare Type	End-Points	Social Person	Spend	Driver
PERSON 1	Male	25	No	Culture	No	Light	Random planner	Rare, Hidden	Yes	Low	Yes
PERSON 2	Female	28	A bit	Adventure	No	Light	Early planner	Cultural, Rare	Yes	High	No
PERSON 3	Male	25	A bit	Culture	No	Medium	Random planner	Cultural	Yes	Medium	Yes
PERSON 4	Male	23	Yes	Adventure	Yes	/	Early planner	Common	Yes	High	No
PERSON 5	Female	21	Yes	Culture	Yes	Heavy	Random planner	Rare, Hidden	Yes	Medium	/
PERSON 6	Female	27	Yes	Culture	Yes	Heavy	Early planner	Common	Yes	Low	Yes
PERSON 7	Male	24	A bit	Adventure	Yes	Light	Random planner	Common	No	High	Yes
PERSON 8	Female	20	No	Adventure	Yes	Medium	Early planner	Rare, Hidden	No	Low	No

Persona 1



NAME

Lucjan Krupa, Pretentious traveler

TYPE

Adventurous&Independent Decision-Maker

About

♂ Male 24 years

📍 Zurich, Switzerland

Single

Student

Persona skills

Research and Analysis



Time management



Adaptability



Budget management



Goals

- Finding new places, cultures and foods
- Breaking society routine
- Balancing comfort and budget
- Having control over travel plans

Quote

“*Life is too short to worry about anything. Seeking comfort but not staying too much into that zone is the perfect balance.*”

Background

“I'm 24 and a student, so I travel on a budget, but I don't mind spending a bit more for comfort. I like to be spontaneous and usually travel light, with just a carry-on. I rely on visuals and other people's feedback when picking places, and I love going back to places where I've had good experiences. I never travel alone—I'm always with friends or a group.”

Technology



Browsers



Characteristics

- **Budget-conscious but values comfort:** While he's on a tight budget as a student, he's willing to pay a bit more for a comfortable experience.
- **Spontaneous and adventurous:** He prefers last-minute trips and doesn't plan far in advance, enjoying the thrill of the unknown.
- **Visual-driven:** He relies on visual elements like pictures and user feedback to decide where to travel.
- **Independent planner:** He prefers to plan every part of his trip himself rather than relying on pre-curated packages.
- **Social traveler:** He enjoys traveling with friends or groups and is open to meeting strangers on his trips.
- **Loves nature, culture, and food:** His main motivations for traveling are experiencing new cultures, enjoying the natural beauty of destinations, and exploring local cuisine.

Demographic

- **37.5%** have a high school diploma or are currently pursuing a university degree
- **75%** live in suburban areas
- **18-25** years old
- **50% male, 50% female**

Touchpoints

- **How they use the product:** He uses the app to quickly find comfortable yet budget-friendly travel options with good visuals and flexible, customizable plans. He prefers having control over the planning process.
- **How they interact with the app:**
 - **Search:** He relies heavily on high-quality images and reviews from other users to make decisions.
 - **Filtering options:** He wants to easily filter by comfort level, price, and location, finding the most relevant options without hassle.
 - **Customization:** He appreciates being able to build his itinerary step-by-step rather than relying on pre-made packages.
 - **Spontaneity:** He uses the app for last-minute travel decisions, so it needs to be quick and efficient, showing him the best options without overwhelming him with too many irrelevant details.

Frustrations

- **Lack of visual appeal on travel platforms:** “I need more pictures to help me decide where to go.”
- **Complex filter options:** “It's frustrating when I can't easily filter through options on travel sites.”
- **Overpriced flights on aggregator sites:** “I don't trust sites like Skyscanner, they never seem to offer the best prices.”
- **Pre-curated travel packages:** “I don't like it when a platform tries to plan everything for me—I prefer making my own decisions.”

Persona 2



NAME

Anna Castillo

TYPE

Comfort-Seeking Explorer

About

Female 25 years

Bern, Switzerland

Engaged

Back-end developer

Persona skills

Research and Analysis



Time management



Adaptability



Social communication



Quote

“

"The best trips are the ones that let me unwind without the crowds."

”

::

Background

"I'm 25, and I love traveling to explore new countries and meet interesting people. I often travel to see family, so I tend to revisit familiar places. Comfort is important to me, so I'll pay a little extra if I can. I plan my trips well in advance—I don't like rushing. I rely on public transportation since I don't have a driver's license, and I prefer to find hidden, less-touristy spots over crowded places."

Technology



Characteristics

- **Comfort-focused but budget-conscious:** She prioritizes comfort but keeps spending within her limits (around \$1,500 per trip).
- **Curious and people-oriented:** She enjoys meeting new people and experiencing new cultures.
- **Thorough planner:** Prefers to organize her trips well in advance to avoid last-minute stress.
- **Simple and practical:** She values simplicity in travel platforms and isn't interested in flashy features.

Demographic

- **37.5%** have a high school diploma or are currently pursuing a university degree
- **75%** live in suburban areas
- **18-25** years old
- **50% male, 50% female**

Touchpoints

- **Why they use the product:** She seeks an easy-to-use platform to find travel deals and organize her plans, with options for comfort and convenience.
- **How they interact with the app:**
 - **Simple navigation:** She wants a straightforward interface to browse deals without unnecessary distractions.
 - **Save options:** Appreciates the ability to save and organize travel ideas for easy access.
 - **Planning tool:** Uses the app to organize trips well ahead of time, allowing her to manage details in advance and avoid last-minute stress.
 - **Cultural and hidden spots:** Looks for recommendations that highlight lesser-known spots and cultural attractions, avoiding tourist-heavy areas.

Frustrations

- **Complexity in travel platforms:** "I want travel platforms to be simple and easy to use, without overwhelming options."
- **Overcrowded tourist spots:** "I don't enjoy crowded, touristy places; I prefer more secluded destinations."
- **Lack of options for saving preferences:** "I wish platforms allowed me to save my options to better organize my travel ideas."

User Journey map



"Life is too short to worry about anything. Seeking comfort but not staying too much into that zone is the perfect balance."

Goals

- Finding new places, cultures and foods
- Breaking society routine
- Balancing comfort and budget
- Having control over travel plans

	Discovery	Initial Interaction	Customizing the Trip	Post-Saving Experience	Loyalty
Touchpoints	• Ads or recommendations on social media. • Word-of-mouth or online travel forums. • App store or website.	• App homepage or dashboard. • Trip creation feature.	• Trip planning screen. • Activity/accommodation/transportation selection features.	• App notifications. • In-trip itinerary management feature.	• Share your itinerary to your community, on social media. • Offers, rewards, or reminders via email or push notifications.
Actions	• Downloads and installs the app after seeing positive reviews. • Briefly checks features to understand the app's functionality.	• Selects a destination based on personal preference or reviews. • Fills in basic trip details like duration, destination, and budget.	• Skips curated packages • Looks for location suggestions given by app • Views detailed info about the location and chooses activities and stays • Selects mode of travel	• Uses the app to keep track of bookings, directions, and check-ins. • Updates itinerary if spontaneous plans change (e.g., adding activities, changing accommodations).	• Receives post-trip surveys to provide feedback and reviews. • Notices personalized recommendations based on previous travel behavior. • Saves personal preferences (e.g., car rental options, types of accommodations)
Thoughts & Customer experience	• "Will this app help me curate my travel plan?" • "I hope this is not like those automated platforms" 	• "I want to find a place that fits my needs culture, food & comfort." • "Hope this allows me to plan the trip without much hassle." 	• "I want control over where I stay and how I get around." • "I hope I can easily see details and reviews without digging too deep." 	• "I want flexibility to adjust plans if needed." • "I Hope I don't have to spend time planning when I am on the trip" 	• "This app remembers my preferences, making it easier to plan my next trip!" • "I hope the recommendations get better as I keep using it." 
Pain Points	Skepticism about how much control the app will give over planning without making it a hassle for me.	• Confusing filter options could be frustrating. • Lack of sufficient images or information about destinations could make decision harder.	• Can be overwhelming amount of work for a single person to handle • Plans are made at last moment. • Plans can change at last moment.	Poor app performance or lack of offline support could be frustrating during travel.	If the app's recommendations or offers feel irrelevant or repetitive, it may lead to disengagement.
Solutions	• Showcase customization features upfront in app onboarding. • Highlight personalized recommendations while still allowing user-driven decisions.	• Allow personalized searches for accommodations, transportation, and activities. • Visual appeal with plenty of high-quality images for better decision-making.	• Share dashboard with friends and editable by all • If planning is being done late, suggest them precurated options and with a little change they can personalize them.	• Enable offline access to the saved itinerary. • Provide real-time updates and recommendations during the trip based on location.	• Offer personalized travel suggestions • loyalty or rewards program • Send timely, well-targeted offers

Pain Points & Opportunities

Skepticism about whether the app will help create a personalized plan and concerns over managing everything.

Showcase customization features during app onboarding, highlighting the personalized recommendations while maintaining user-driven control.

01

02

Users have different preferences when choosing a location, influenced by factors like mood, budget, culture, food, comfort, and adventure.

Build a platform where users can explore various locations, visualize them as part of their journey, and have an intuitive, low-learning-curve experience for managing their plans.

Users want to explore multiple stays and choose their preferred travel vehicles.

Include features that allow users to explore different accommodation options with detailed attributes like location, pictures, reviews, and amenities. Enable vehicle selection with comparison options for comfort, crowd, travel time, and luggage compatibility.

03

04

When users plan in groups, coordination is a challenge as multiple people contribute to the planning.

Make curated plans shareable among friends, allowing simultaneous collaboration and seamless exchange of ideas.

08

Uncertainty about what will encourage users to return to the platform.

Save user preferences to offer better suggestions each time they use the platform, introduce a loyalty or rewards program, and send timely, targeted offers that cater to their travel habits.

Poor app performance or lack of offline support can be frustrating while traveling.

Integrate offline support and provide real-time location-based updates and recommendations to enhance the travel experience even without connectivity.

07

06

Plans may change at the last minute due to new discoveries or unexpected delays.

Design the app to be adaptable for last-minute changes, allowing users to edit their plans anytime, anywhere, with real-time suggestions to save time.

05

Late planning requires flexible, quick adjustments rather than perfect, detailed plans.

Provide users with pre-curated plans that they can easily modify to suit their needs, simplifying last-minute planning.

Our Planning Dashboard
help(s) youngsters
who want to
curate their personalized vacation plan
by not imposing precured plans
and enabling fluid planning .
(unlike KAYAK, Tripmasters)

Our Platform
help(s) Group Members
who want to
Plan a vacation together
by reducing repetitive work
and sharing current progress made by members .
(unlike typical vacation curators)

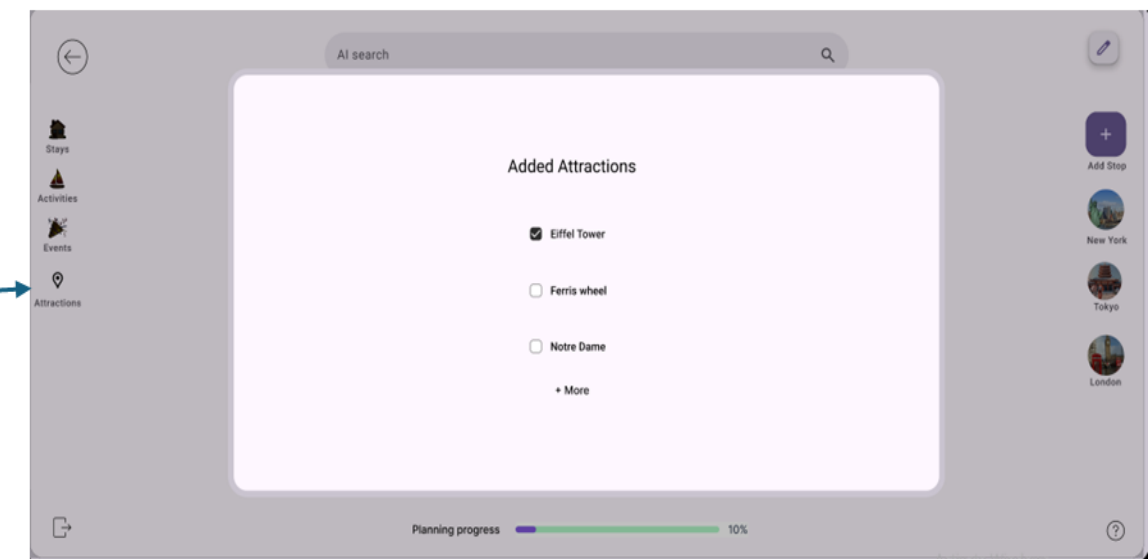
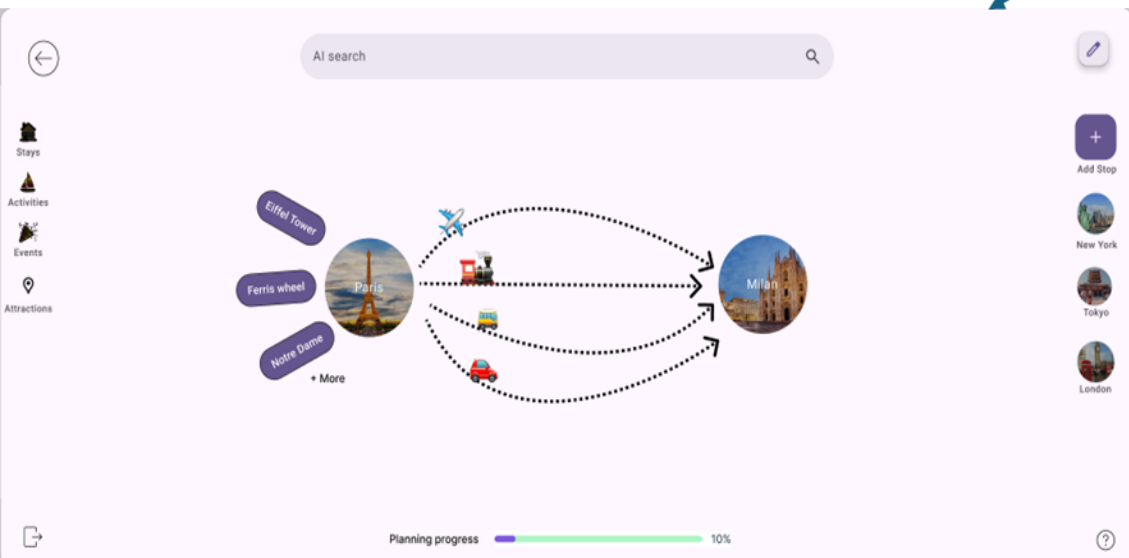
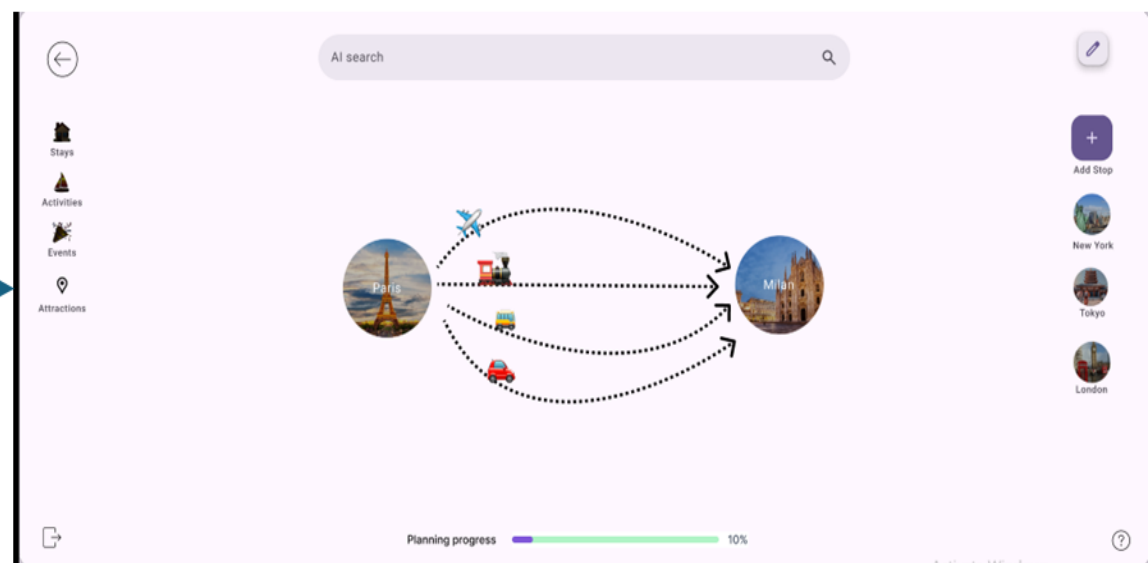
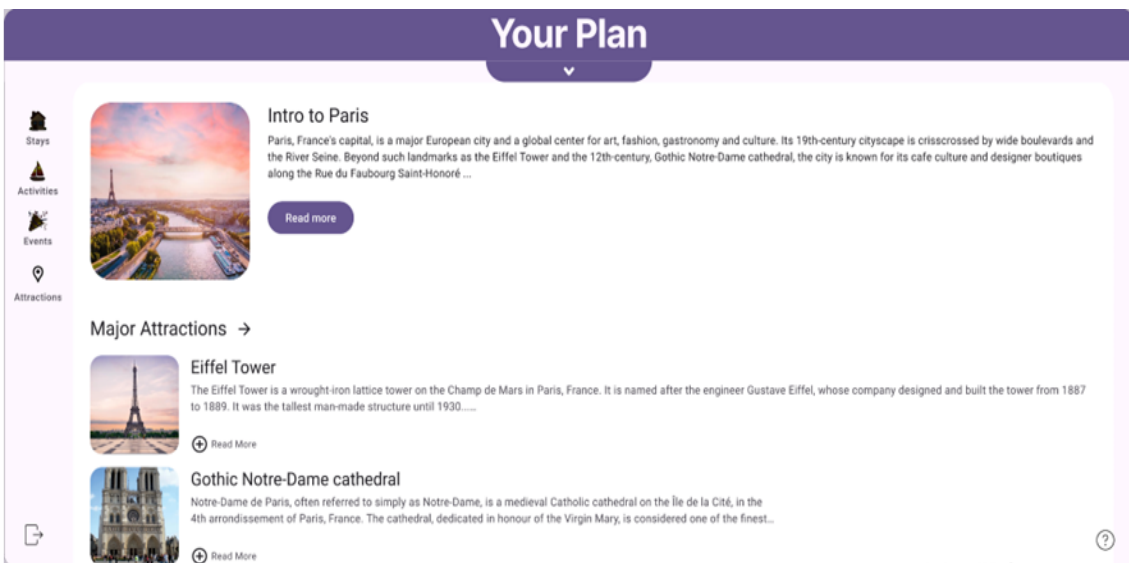
Our platform
help(s) last minute planners
who want to
enjoy the vacation without worrying about every step
by reducing planning time and last minute jargons
and provide a well trusted plan which they can change according to their needs .
(unlike typical vacation curators)

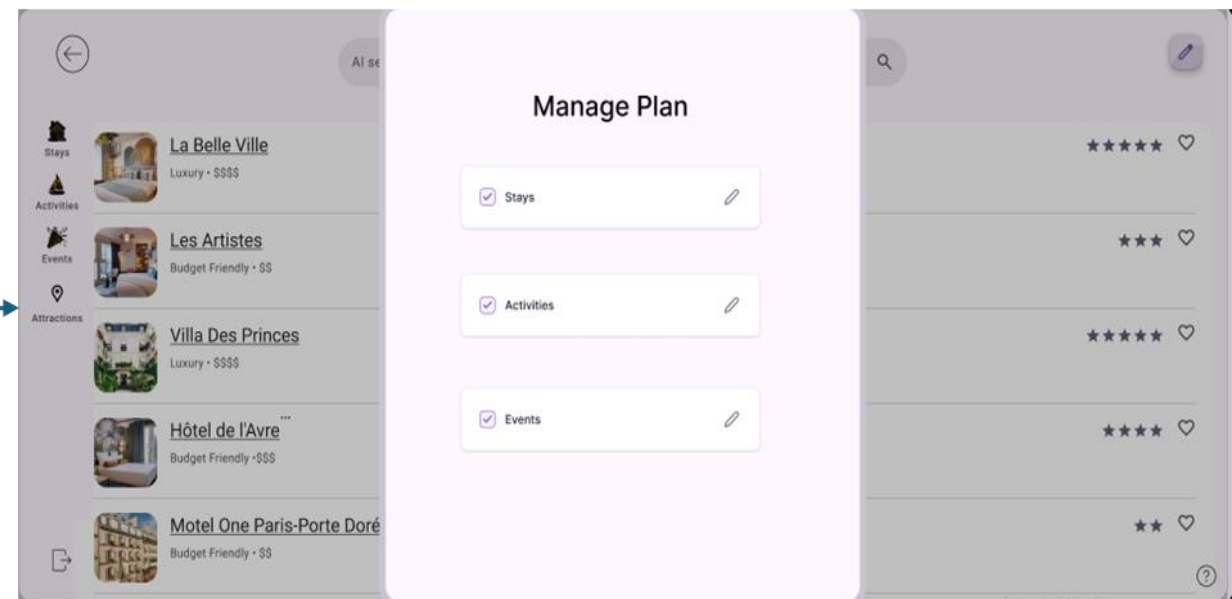
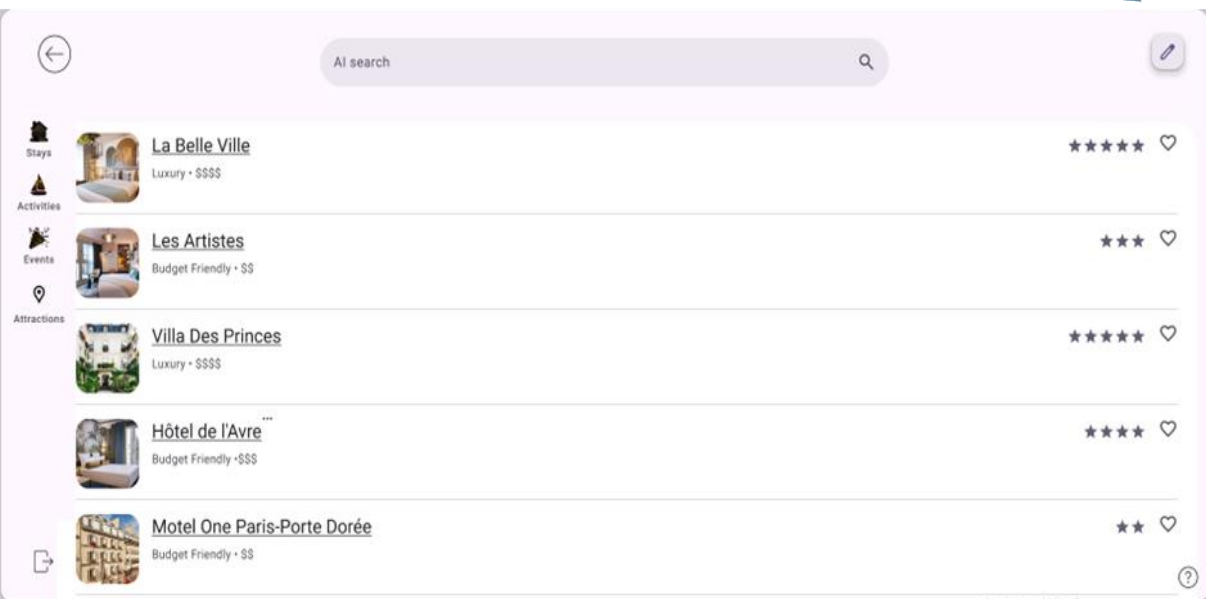
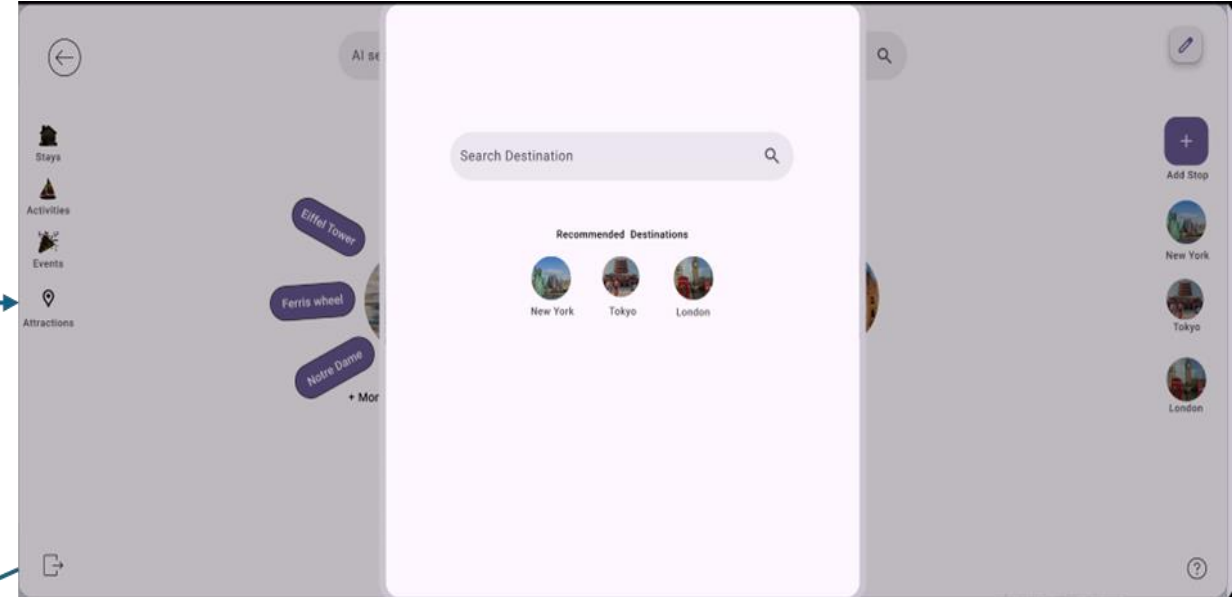
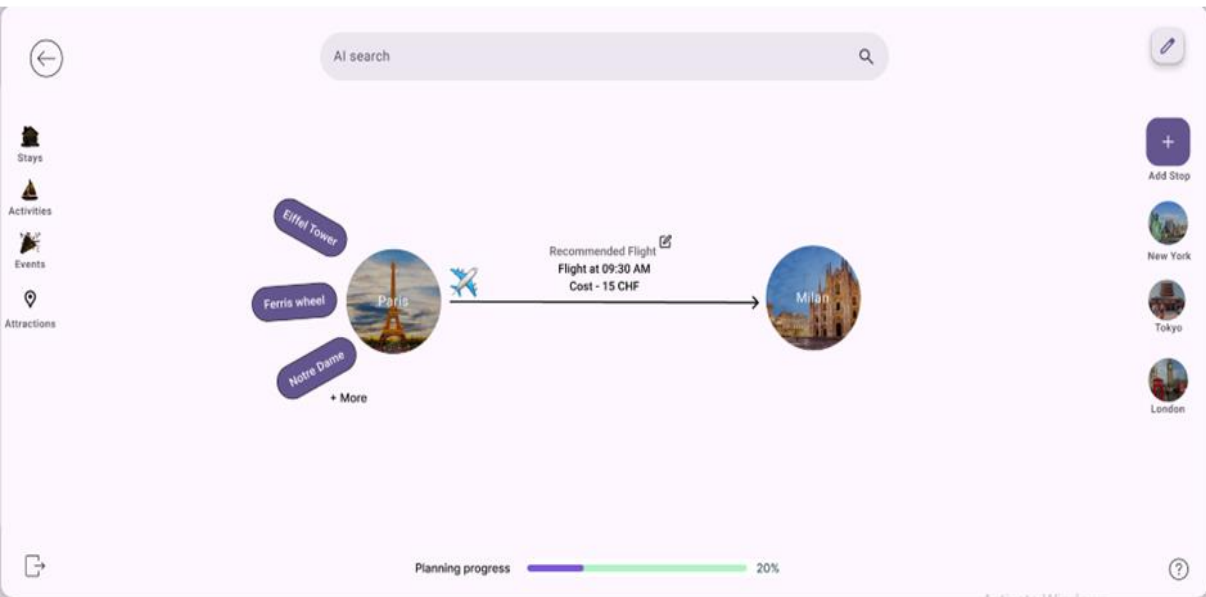
Our platform
help(s) youngsters
who want to
choose the best curations possible for them
by reducing complexity induced from several options
and enabling techniques to compare stays and travel options .
(unlike other travel and hotel aggregators)

Our platform
help(s) frequent travellers
who want to
curate ideas regularly
by reducing decision fatigue
and recommending from saved personal preferences (e.g., car rental options, types of accommodations) .
(unlike typical travel curators)

Our platform
help(s) travellers
who want to
travel to remote locations
by avoiding accessibility issues
and enabling offline access and GPS based notifications .
(unlike typical travel aggregators)

Our UX Vision





Your Plan



Stays



Activities



Events



Attractions



Intro to Paris

Paris, France's capital, is a major European city and a global center for art, fashion, gastronomy and culture. Its 19th-century cityscape is crisscrossed by wide boulevards and the River Seine. Beyond such landmarks as the Eiffel Tower and the 12th-century, Gothic Notre-Dame cathedral, the city is known for its cafe culture and designer boutiques along the Rue du Faubourg Saint-Honoré ...

Read more

Major Attractions →



Eiffel Tower

The Eiffel Tower is a wrought-iron lattice tower on the Champ de Mars in Paris, France. It is named after the engineer Gustave Eiffel, whose company designed and built the tower from 1887 to 1889. It was the tallest man-made structure until 1930.....

+ Read More



Gothic Notre-Dame cathedral

Notre-Dame de Paris, often referred to simply as Notre-Dame, is a medieval Catholic cathedral on the Île de la Cité, in the 4th arrondissement of Paris, France. The cathedral, dedicated in honour of the Virgin Mary, is considered one of the finest...

COLLECTION OF ANNOTATED BEST PRACTICES

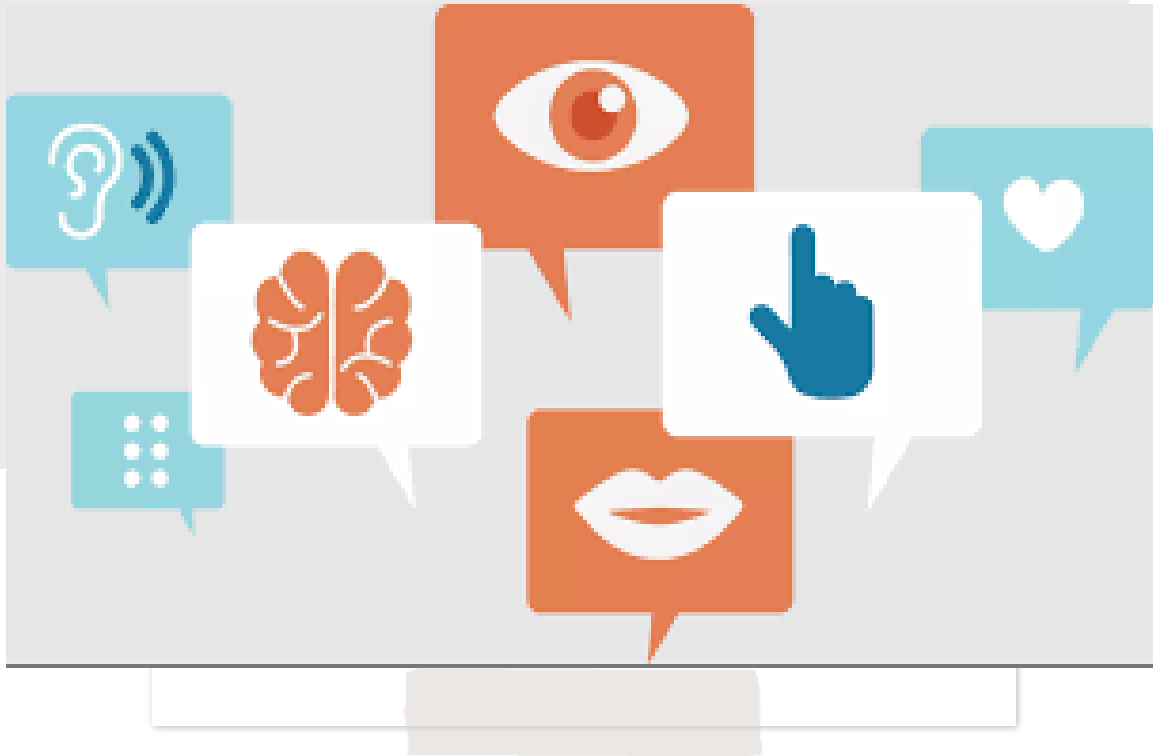
Simplicity and Clarity

Prioritizing simplicity and clarity in the app enhances the user experience across multiple dimensions:

- **Enhances Usability:** A clean, straightforward interface makes it easier for users to navigate and complete tasks quickly.
- **Reduces Cognitive Load:** Minimalistic design helps users focus on essential actions without being overwhelmed by unnecessary details.
- **Improves User Retention:** By creating a smooth experience, users are more likely to return, knowing the app is easy to use.
- **Speeds Up Decision-Making:** Clear options allow users to make confident choices faster, ideal for time-sensitive travel planning.

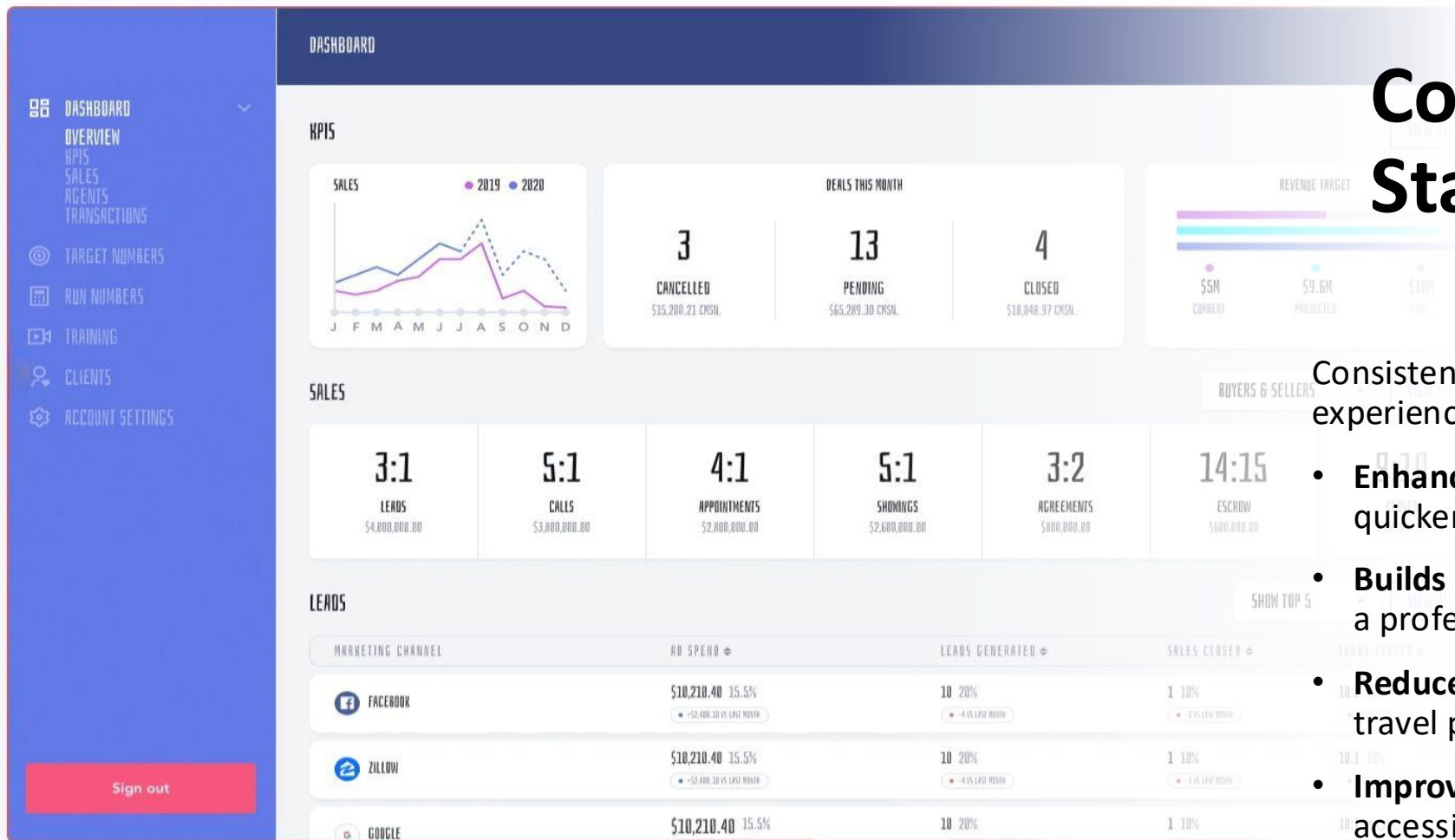


Accessibility and Inclusivity



Design choices need to accommodate diverse user needs and preferences:

- **Colorblind-Friendly:** Uses accessible colors for readability.
- **Audio Assistance:** Provides navigation support for visually impaired users.
- **Custom Preferences:** Allows saving allergy/disability needs for travel services.
- **Cultural Sensitivity:** Considers dietary restrictions to respect diverse practices.



Consistency and Standards

Consistency in UX fosters a seamless, reliable experience for users:

- **Enhances Usability:** Familiar layouts make tasks quicker and reduce errors.
- **Builds Trust:** Consistent design standards create a professional, reliable feel.
- **Reduces Cognitive Load:** Users can focus on travel planning, not navigation.
- **Improves Accessibility:** Consistency supports accessibility, aiding all users.



Compatibility

Ensuring compatibility in UX makes the app intuitive and accessible for a diverse user base:

- **Meets Expectations:** Aligns with standard app behaviors, minimizing confusion for users.
- **Increases Satisfaction:** Considers user preferences, leading to higher engagement.
- **Builds Trust:** Predictable interactions boost user confidence, essential for travel planning.
- **Broadens Accessibility:** Makes the app welcoming for varied demographics and experience levels.

Visibility of the System Status

Keeping users informed of their current location and progress in the app ensures a clear experience:

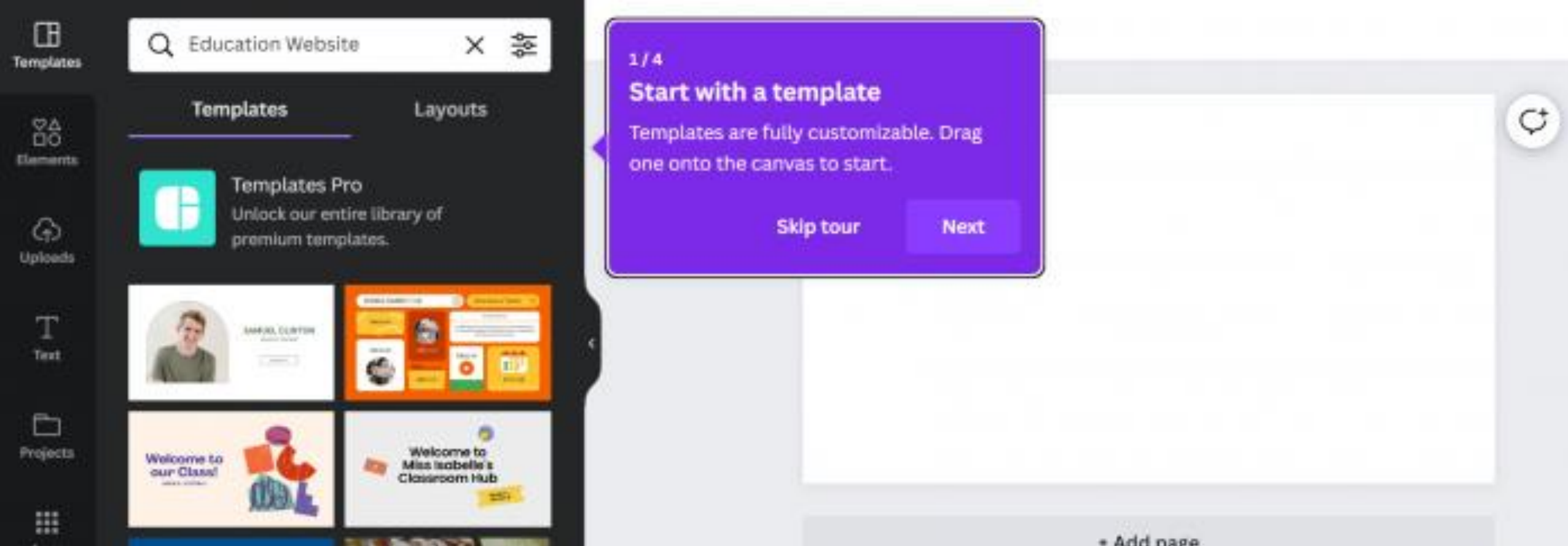
- **Boosts Confidence:** Real-time updates help users feel assured and focused on their tasks.
- **Reduces Confusion:** Constant visibility keeps users oriented, minimizing backtracking.
- **Enhances Progression:** Progress indicators clarify next steps in complex tasks.
- **Improves Navigation:** Clear system status means users can complete tasks efficiently.

Your progress

39% to complete

🕒 22min





Help and Documentation

Accessible help resources allow users to navigate independently and solve issues quickly:

- **Empowers Users:** Easy-to-find support reduces dependence on external help.
- **Minimizes Frustration:** Clear solutions boost user satisfaction.
- **Aids Learning:** Guides help new users explore features confidently.
- **Builds Trust:** Knowing help is available encourages users to rely on the app.

Consolidated summary of the interviews

	GENDER	AVERAGE AGE	AVERAGE BUDGET PER TRIP	REVISIT	PRE-DONE PLANS	SITES THEY DISLIKE	EARLY PLANNER	END-POINTS	SOCIAL PERSON	COUNTRY OR EVENT	PUBLIC TRANSP. OR OWN CAR
SUM=	4 males 4 females	24.125	1433.333	4 yes 4 no	1 yes 1 maybe 6 no	Booking AirBnB SkyScanner TripAdvisor	4 yes 4 no	4 rare 3 hidden 2 cultural 3 common	6 yes 2 no	5 country 1 event 2 both	4 public 3 own car

THANKS FOR YOUR ATTENTION! 🤪